

5 Signs He's Pulling Away

and What To Do About It

This free guide gives you the five clearest behavioural signals that a man is emotionally withdrawing — and the specific, research-grounded responses that actually help.

Understanding why men pull away is the first step to responding in a way that draws him back rather than pushing him further.

Sign 1

He Responds More Slowly — and His Messages Get Shorter

He used to reply within minutes. Now it's hours. His messages, once warm and detailed, have shrunk to one-word answers. This shift in communication pace is one of the earliest and most reliable signals that a man is emotionally withdrawing. It is not always intentional — avoidant men often reduce contact as an automatic response to feeling overwhelmed by closeness.

What to do:

Resist the urge to send follow-up messages asking if he's okay. Give him space for 24–48 hours. Men who are pulling away due to emotional overwhelm almost always re-engage when they don't feel pursued. Match his energy calmly rather than escalating yours.

Sign 2

He Stops Initiating Plans

When a man is fully engaged, he actively seeks your company. He suggests weekends away, impromptu dinners, or even just coffee. When the initiating stops — when every plan becomes something you engineer — it is a clear sign he is emotionally retreating. He may still show up when invited, but that effortless pursuit has gone quiet.

What to do:

Don't manufacture urgency by planning back-to-back events. Step back, leave space in the calendar, and notice whether he fills it. A man who wants to be with you will find a way to be with you. Filling the silence yourself only delays the clarity you actually need.

Sign 3

Physical and Emotional Affection Has Quietly Reduced

The hand-holding that used to happen automatically. The small moments of tenderness — a hand on your back, a spontaneous compliment. When these fade, it often goes unnoticed at first because the change is gradual. But one day you realise: the warmth that defined the early relationship has been replaced by a polite, comfortable distance.

What to do:

Before assuming the worst, create low-pressure opportunities for connection: a walk, a quiet evening without phones, a film at home. Avoidant men often re-engage through shared activity rather than direct emotional conversation. Don't force the conversation too early — let connection rebuild naturally first.

Sign 4

He Becomes Vague About the Future

A man who is emotionally present makes future plans freely. He mentions holidays, events, things you'll do together. When he starts avoiding forward references — when 'we should do that sometime' replaces specific plans — it signals internal ambivalence. He is keeping his options emotionally open, even if he hasn't articulated why.

What to do:

Do not press for reassurance about where the relationship is going. Reassurance-seeking typically pushes avoidant men further away. Instead, stay lightly engaged, maintain your own life and plans, and let him see — through your behaviour, not your words — that you are not dependent on his commitment.

Sign 5

He Mentions Needing Space or Feeling Overwhelmed

This is the most explicit signal and the one women most often misread. When a man says he needs space, the anxious response is to interpret this as rejection and to push back against it. In reality, avoidantly-attached men genuinely require periods of emotional independence to regulate themselves. The request for space is not a breakup announcement — it is an attachment system in self-protection mode.

What to do:

Give him the space he has asked for — completely and without conditions. Do not reframe it as temporary withdrawal. Do not send 'I just wanted to check in' messages. Use the time to invest in your own friendships, goals, and wellbeing. Men with avoidant attachment are far more likely to return when their request for space is genuinely respected.

Go Deeper

If these five signs resonated, you're ready for the full picture. *Why He Pulls Away: The Attachment Science That Explains Every Confusing Thing Men Do* covers the complete framework — the three attachment styles, how they interact in relationships, and the specific communication strategies that build secure connection with avoidant men.

Available at: <https://middleton26.gumroad.com/l/tbnqe> | £12.97